

BUSINESS OPERATIONS

Business Operations & Systems Workbook

Identify scattered records, unclear responsibilities, inefficient workflows, and digital systems that need attention.

A process is working reliably when it has a clear owner, a known trigger, a defined home for information, a way to verify the outcome, and a plan for what happens when the system fails.

Business snapshot

Field	Current picture
Business stage / team size	
Primary products or services	
Current operational pain points	
Top three priorities	

Self-rating

Rate each area from 1 (mostly manual or unclear) to 5 (documented, owned, and repeatable).

Area	1	2	3	4	5	Note
Organization	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	
Documentation	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	
Financial administration	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	
Customer workflow	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	
Digital systems / access	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	
Recurring task management	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	

Top operational symptoms

Information entered more than once, tasks depending on memory, records living in personal accounts, delays without ownership, or missing follow-up are common signs that the process needs structure.

Records and administration

The purpose of this page is not to store everything; it is to decide what matters enough to have a defined place, owner, access, and retention decision.

Record area	Where stored?	Owner	Current?	Missing / follow-up
Company and governance				
Financial and tax				
Insurance and risk				
Clients / customers				
Vendors / contractors				
Agreements and policies				
Licenses and registrations				

Record health check

- ☐ Can the latest version be found in under two minutes?
- ☐ Is access appropriate for the person who needs it?
- ☐ Is there a backup or safe alternate location?
- ☐ Is ownership clear when someone is unavailable?
- ☐ Is the record still needed, or does it have a review/archive plan?

Which record is hardest to find quickly?

Which record category depends on one person?

A usable record system

A record has a reliable home, an accountable owner, appropriate access, a retention decision, and a way to confirm the current version is complete.

Recurring responsibilities

Operational reliability usually breaks down where recurring work is not scheduled, owned, or checked. This page helps separate recurring obligations from ad hoc problems.

Responsibility	Owner	Frequency	Due date	Backup person	Status
Bookkeeping review		Monthly			
Payroll / contractor review					
Invoicing / receivables					
Tax or filing deadline					
License / vendor renewal					
Backup / access review					
Insurance renewal		Annual			
Document / policy review					

Cadence notes

Weekly responsibilities

Monthly and quarterly responsibilities

Annual responsibilities

Fail-safe question

If the normal owner is unavailable, what happens? A process with no backup is still a weak point.

Client and internal workflows

A business often has more friction at the handoff points than in the work itself. These are places where work moves between people, systems, or steps without a clear owner or confirmation.

Workflow	Current process	Owner	System used	Friction / improvement
Client inquiry				
Lead follow-up / consultation				
Intake / agreement				
Invoice / payment				
Service delivery				
Document storage / completion				
Follow-up				
Issue escalation				
Vendor onboarding				

Workflow map

Inquiry → Qualification → Consultation → Intake → Agreement → Payment → Service → Completion → Follow-up

Friction signals

- ☐ Work starts before agreement or payment is confirmed
- ☐ Status questions are repeated because nobody knows the current state
- ☐ Files are lost in email or a personal account
- ☐ Someone is the only person who understands a process
- ☐ A process has no clear confirmation step

Look for handoff failures

Delays often occur where responsibility moves between people or systems. Identify the trigger, owner, expected output, and confirmation for each handoff.

Digital system inventory

Technology should support operations, not create another layer of confusion. Ask whether each system is still doing work, whether the cost is known, and whether the business truly owns it.

System	Provider / owner	Purpose	Cost / renewal	Issue	Keep / replace / review
Website / domain					
Email / scheduling					
CRM / customer records					
Cloud storage / forms					
Bookkeeping / payments					
Automation / reporting					
Password / access management					
Backups					

Cost and access check

- ☐ Is this system still used regularly?
- ☐ Does it duplicate another tool or workflow?
- ☐ Is the renewal date known and documented?
- ☐ Is the account business-owned?
- ☐ Is recovery access available to an authorized backup person?
- ☐ Can the business still access its data if the current owner leaves?

Account ownership

Core business systems should not depend solely on an employee, contractor, or former vendor's personal account. Confirm business-controlled ownership, recovery, billing, and backup access.

Priority action plan

This final page helps turn the assessment into a practical sequence rather than a long list of tasks.

Reflection

What creates the most friction or is easiest to miss?

What information is duplicated or what process is undocumented?

What system no longer serves the business?

What access or ownership needs clarification?

Priority matrix

Urgent + important	Important, not urgent	Monitor	Later

First three fixes

Priority	Action	Owner	Deadline	Status
1				
2				
3				

Why this first

The first fix should usually address a real risk, a repeated delay, or a missing owner. It should be specific enough to know when it is done.

Next step

Need help turning the assessment into a practical plan? Schedule a consultation at getalchemize.com.

This workbook provides general operational guidance. It is not a cybersecurity audit, managed IT service, legal review, compliance certification, or guarantee of business performance.